favorite subject, and wrote a number of monographs, which I published under the collective title, *On The Principle of the Increase of Entropy*. In these articles I discussed the laws of chemical reactions, of the dissociation of gases, and finally the properties of dilute solutions. With respect to the latter, my theory led to the conclusion that the values of the lowering of the freezing point, observed in many salt solutions, could be explained only by a dissociation of the substances dissolved, and that this finding constituted a thermodynamic foundation for the electrolytic dissociation theory advanced by Svante Arrhenius approximately at the same time. This conclusion, unfortunately, got me into an unpleasant conflict. For Arrhenius challenged, in a rather unfriendly manner, the admissibility of my arguments, pointing out that his theory related to ions, i.e. electrically charged particles. I could reply only that the laws of thermodynamics were valid regardless of whether or not the particles carried a charge.

In the spring of 1889, after the death of Kirchhoff, I accepted the invitation, extended to me upon the recommendation of the Faculty of Philosophy of Berlin, to take his place at the University, to teach theoretical physics. First, I was an associate professor, and from 1892, a full professor. These were the years of the widest expansion of my scientific outlook and way of thinking. For this was the first time that I came in closer contact with the world leaders in scientific research in those days—Helmholtz, above all the others. But I learned to know Helmholtz also as a human being, and to respect him as a man no less than I had always respected him as a scientist. For with his entire personality, integrity of convictions and modesty of character, he was the very incarnation of the dignity and probity of science. These traits of character were supplemented by a true human kindness, which touched my heart deeply. When during a conversation he would look at me with those calm, searching, penetrating, and yet so benign eyes, I would be overwhelmed by a feeling of boundless filial trust and devotion, and I would feel that I could confide in him, without reservation, everything that I had on my mind, knowing that I would find him a fair and tolerant judge; and a single word of approval, let alone praise, from his lips would make me as happy as any worldly triumph.

I had this experience on several occasions. One of them was when he thanked me emphatically after my memorial address on Heinrich Hertz, delivered before the Physical Society; another, when he expressed his agreement with my theory of chemical solutions, shortly before my election to the Prussian Academy of Sciences. I shall treasure the memory of every one of these thrilling moments to the end of my days.

Besides Helmholtz, I was soon on amicable terms with Wilhelm von Bezold, whom I had known from Munich. Likewise, with August Kundt, the temperamental Director of the Physical Institute, universally liked for his